

For Indian consumer tech brands like Noise, this isn't new. "India is the country for youngsters. We would be the fastest to absorb any technology that comes in—it just has to make sense in our lives," says Gaurav Khatri, Founder of Noise.

Youth has always been central to Noise's strategy. Nearly 33% of its users are aged below 24, with another 33% between 24 and 34. But Khatri says Gen Z buyers are markedly different from millennials. "They are far more specific about solving one problem at a time," he explains. "For sleep, they want one device. For GPS-led activities, another. They don't want one device doing everything."

This is forcing brands to rethink product design and portfolio strategy. As core technologies mature and innovation plateaus, differentiation increasingly comes from lifestyle relevance. "Consumers today understand wearables far better than they did five years ago," says Khatri. "It's no longer just a watch or a step counter. It's an evolved product designed for specific use cases."

From Deloitte's vantage point, this shift is clearly visible across categories. Wearables, smart home and security devices, gaming and emerging interfaces continue to see strong traction, even as smartphones remain central. "Growth energy now sits in audio—TWS earbuds and smart speakers—because Gen Z's leisure and learning are audio-first," Ramanathan notes. Music, podcasts, creator content and short video dominate daily consumption, making audio devices a natural extension.

Quick commerce availability and omnichannel 'try-and-buy' models are further accelerating adoption. Experience centres, AR demos and same-day delivery are boosting accessory attach rates, a behaviour

Ramanathan likens to patterns seen in travel and leisure, where experience-led choices and premium upgrades are becoming the norm.

Importantly, Gen Z is shopping more mindfully. Deloitte's analyses point to a dual trend—premiumisation coupled with value consciousness. Gen Z is willing to pay a premium when a device aligns with a clear purpose, be it wellness, safety or creativity, and ethics such as clean materials, energy efficiency and sustainability.

eat, and features like touchscreens, long expected in cars and scooters, are now moving indoors.

The opportunity ahead is massive. But tapping this market requires a reset in go-to-market strategies. "Go-to-market is being rebuilt around content-led funnels," says Ramanathan. Creator videos drive awareness, micro-influencers build credibility for niche specifications, and short-form explainers convert interest into action.

For consumer tech companies,

For brands, winning this generation early could ensure long-term loyalty. But there is a catch: Gen Z demands relevance and authenticity

In home technology, for instance, the growing uptake of low-energy smart devices suggests sustainability is a functional specification that can tip purchase decisions when the price difference is modest. Privacy, too, is emerging as a critical factor. While Gen Z thrives on social discovery, heightened anxiety around health and economic uncertainty has made them cautious. Brands that communicate transparent data practices and permission-based sharing are gaining trust, particularly in categories like cameras, smart locks and wearables.

Even the kitchen is being reimaged. "Gen Z consumers are increasingly willing to pay a premium for smart, tech-enabled appliances," says Mahek Mody, founder of Upliance.ai, an AI cooking assistant start-up. Young consumers want greater control over what they

this means rethinking everything from product pages to backend operations. Creator content, live demos and upgrade offers are now embedded into digital storefronts, while physical retail is being augmented with smart shelves and assisted selling. Behind the scenes, AI-led demand forecasting and automated warehouses are helping brands respond to sudden spikes triggered by viral content.

D2C-native brands are leveraging quick commerce for accessories and trials, while legacy players are localising creator strategies across Tier II and III markets, where young cohorts are rising fast.

For India's consumer tech ecosystem, Gen Z is redefining how technology is discovered, evaluated and consumed, one scroll, one reel and one gadget at a time. **BT**

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